

MIKE E. UNDERWOOD

Principal / Staff Solutions Architect

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SUMMARY

Principal and Staff-level Solutions Architect with deep experience designing distributed systems, modernizing legacy platforms, and leading architecture across high-volume transactional environments. Known for bringing clarity to complex systems, defining service boundaries, and guiding cross-functional teams through modernization, cloud adoption, and integration-heavy initiatives. Skilled at shaping technical roadmaps, improving system reliability, and aligning architecture with business strategy across financial services, insurance, healthcare, retail, and digital consulting organizations.

CORE CAPABILITIES

Architecture and System Design

- Distributed systems and asynchronous workflows
- Event-driven architecture using Azure Service Bus and AWS Lambda
- API-first design, integration patterns, workflow and orchestration modeling
- Modular monolith to service-aligned modernization
- Multitenant and compliance-aligned architecture (PCI, HIPAA)

Cloud, Infrastructure, and Operations

- Azure (AKS, Functions, App Services, Service Bus) and AWS Lambda
- Kubernetes, Docker, IaC patterns, CI/CD with Azure DevOps and GitHub Actions
- Observability pipelines, distributed tracing, telemetry, SRE-aligned reliability
- Performance tuning and systemic issue diagnosis

Engineering Foundations

- C#, .NET, Java, C++, JavaScript, TypeScript
- REST and JSON APIs, middleware, service composition
- SQL Server, Azure SQL, MySQL, Oracle

Leadership and Delivery

- Architecture governance and roadmap development
- Cross-functional alignment across engineering, product, security, and infrastructure
- Partner enablement, workshops, whiteboarding, and technical communication
- Mentoring and guiding teams to preserve architectural intent

SELECTED ARCHITECTURE AND MODERNIZATION HIGHLIGHTS

- Designed distributed, event-driven workflows using Azure Service Bus and AWS Lambda, improving reliability and reducing processing latency.
- Built cloud-native architectures across AKS, Azure Functions, and serverless components, increasing deployment frequency and reducing incident volume.
- Modernized legacy platforms into API-first, domain-aligned services, accelerating delivery cycles and reducing operational cost.
- Implemented observability pipelines with distributed tracing and telemetry to diagnose systemic issues and improve performance.
- Architected multitenant payment workflows with PCI-aligned controls supporting thousands of financial institutions.
- Led modernization of a high-volume payments platform (Informix and C to C#, Unix to PowerShell, Informix to SQL Server), improving performance by 30 percent.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Rightpoint Consulting - Solutions Architect, Digital Operations Architecture

Remote • Jan 2020 to Nov 2025

Architected and delivered enterprise solutions across CMS, healthcare, financial services, entertainment, retail, and ecommerce platforms. Combined hands-on engineering with architectural leadership to guide modernization, integrations, and cloud-native delivery.

Key Contributions

- Architected CMS and digital experience platforms using ASP.NET Core, React, and headless integration patterns.
- Designed backend payment workflows using .NET Web APIs, Azure Service Bus, and AWS Lambda for reliable, event-driven processing.
- Built cloud deployment architectures across AKS, Azure VMs, and serverless components; implemented CI/CD pipelines and observability instrumentation.
- Authored API specifications, integration contracts, reference architectures, and reusable templates for engineering teams.
- Diagnosed systemic issues across APIs, data layers, and cloud infrastructure using distributed tracing and telemetry.

- Mentored engineering teams on implementation patterns, debugging, and code quality to preserve architectural intent.
- Leveraged GitHub Copilot and Microsoft Copilot to accelerate implementation and improve architectural consistency across teams.

AXIS Capital - Application Delivery Lead, Enterprise Architecture

Alpharetta, GA • Mar 2018 to Dec 2019

Provided architectural leadership for enterprise initiatives, aligning application and integration architectures with CIO-level objectives.

Key Contributions

- Translated business requirements into application and integration architectures aligned with EA principles.
- Built automation tooling to streamline deployment, testing, and engineering workflows.
- Improved system reliability through targeted fixes, code reviews, and cross-team collaboration.
- Coordinated distributed teams as Scrum Master and technical lead.

Fiserv — Principal Solutions Architect and Senior Architecture Roles

Alpharetta, GA • Dec 1999 to Feb 2018

Led modernization of high-volume payment, billing, and money-movement platforms used by thousands of financial institutions.

Principal Solutions Architect (Aug 2014 – Feb 2018)

- Defined a three-year business and technology roadmap for the CheckFreePay division.
- Led modernization of the Walk-In Payments platform, migrating legacy Informix and Unix systems to modern .NET and SQL Server architectures.
- Applied a Strangler Fig approach to decompose legacy workflows into domain-aligned services.
- Designed barcode-based POS payment workflows and supporting .NET Web Service APIs.
- Ensured PCI-aligned architecture and audit-ready operational controls.

Manager & Lead Senior Software Architect (Mar 2012 – Jul 2014)

- Led modernization initiatives and delivery of a unified .NET Web Service API layer across .NET and Java products.
- Managed the Biller Solutions architecture team, including hiring, coaching, and performance evaluation.
- Developed an architecture roadmap aligned with business strategy.

Senior Software Architect (Sep 2008 – Feb 2012)

- Delivered the eBill Easy Activation platform, increasing activations by 230 percent.
- Built cross-platform authentication, reducing digital certificates from hundreds to one.
- Architected SaaS APIs used by more than 4,000 financial sponsors including Bank of America.

Software Architect and Senior Software Engineer (Jul 2001 – Aug 2008)

- Built Java and ASP.NET payment solutions, several commercialized or sold to third parties.
- Designed Java biller-direct payment platforms integrating iSeries and mainframe systems.
- Co-designed .NET-based SOA exposing mainframe payment and billing capabilities.

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Computer Information Systems – Georgia State University

BBA, Computer Information Systems – Georgia State University

CERTIFICATIONS

Sitecore Experience Solution 9 Developer